

Absolutely — **whenever** is a very useful grammar/polyfunctionality target because your passage uses it here:

> “**Whenever** her tomatoes or lemons are ready, she gives some to neighbours and relatives...”

Here **whenever** means **every time that / on every occasion when**.

Word family / grammar family: **when / whenever**

Base related form: when

Target: whenever

Part of speech / function: subordinating conjunction (從屬連接詞) / relative adverb-like use (關係副詞式用法)

Unlike a lexical word such as *garden* or *colour*, **whenever** has a fairly compact semantic range. Its importance is mainly grammatical.

Meaning in your passage: **whenever = every time that — 每當 ; 每次.....時**

Your sentence:

> “**Whenever** her tomatoes or lemons are ready, she gives some to neighbours and relatives...”

Here **whenever** means:

> **every time her tomatoes or lemons reach the stage when they are ready to be picked or shared.**

繁體中文 :

每一次某情況發生時 ; 每當.....的時候

Natural translation:

> “Whenever her tomatoes or lemons are ready, she gives some to neighbours and relatives.”

「**每當**她的番茄或檸檬成熟可以採收時 , 她就會送一些給鄰居和親戚。」

So here:

> **whenever = every time that = 每當 / 每次.....時**

1. **whenever + clause = every time that — 每當 ; 每次.....時**

This is the core use and your exact source meaning.

Practice 1 — Original

> “**Whenever** her tomatoes or lemons are ready, she gives some away.”

「**每當**她的番茄或檸檬成熟時，她就會送一些出去。」

Practice 2

> “**Whenever** I visit her, she shows me the garden.”

「**每次**我去探望她，她都會帶我看看花園。」

Practice 3

> “Call me whenever you need help.”

「你**每逢 / 每當**需要幫忙時都可以打給我。」

whenever = 某事情每一次發生時，另一件事情也發生

2. **whenever = at any time that — 無論甚麼時候；任何時候**

A broader use.

Practice 4

> “Come **whenever** you like.”

「你**甚麼時候想來都可以**。」

Practice 5

> “You can water the plants whenever it is convenient.”

「你可以在**任何方便的時候**替植物澆水。」

whenever = 不限定具體時間；任何符合條件的時候都可以

Here Chinese often becomes:

> 無論甚麼時候

> 任何時候

> 隨時

3. **whenever = no matter when — 無論何時**

This strongly emphasizes that the exact time does not matter.

Practice 6

> “**Whenever** you decide to start, I’ll support you.”

「**無論你甚麼時候**決定開始，我都會支持你。」

Practice 7

> “Whenever he arrives, we’ll be ready.”

「**無論他甚麼時候**到，我們都會準備好。」

whenever = 無論事情在甚麼時間發生，主句內容都成立

This overlaps strongly with #2, so I would treat them as one broad “any time / no matter when” sense rather than separate lexical meanings.

4. **whenever = each occasion on which something happens — 每逢；凡是……的時候**

A repeated-habit use.

Practice 8

> “She smiles **whenever** she talks about gardening.”

「她**每逢**談到園藝都會笑。」

Practice 9

> “The dog barks whenever someone approaches the gate.”

「**每當**有人走近大門，那隻狗就會叫。」

whenever = 描述有規律重複的情況：A 每次發生，B 都跟著發生

This is conceptually the same core meaning as #1.

5. **whenever-clause before or after the main clause — 每當..... /時**

Word order is flexible.

Pattern A

> **Whenever** I feel stressed, I go for a walk.

「**每當**我感到有壓力，我就去散步。」

Pattern B

> I go for a walk **whenever** I feel stressed.

「我**每當**感到有壓力時都會去散步。」

The meaning is essentially the same.

If the **whenever-clause comes first**, a comma is normally used.

6. **whenever + present simple for repeated/future reference — 每當 / 無論何時.....**

Like other time clauses, **whenever** commonly uses present tense even when the main clause refers to the future.

Practice 10

> “I’ll help you **whenever you need me**.”

「你**任何時候需要我**，我都會幫你。」

Not normally:

> *whenever you will need me* ❌

Practice 11

> “Whenever the fruit is ready, we’ll pick it.”

「水果**每當成熟時**，我們就會採收。」

****whenever-clause = 表未來時間時，通常仍用現在式，而不是 will****

Important grammar point.

7. ****whenever + past tense = every time in the past — 每當以前……時****

Practice 12

> “Whenever I visited her as a child, the house was full of plants.”

「我小時候****每次去探望她****，她家裡都種滿植物。」

Practice 13

> “She brought us fruit whenever she came.”

「她以前****每次來****都會帶水果給我們。」

****whenever + past = 描述過去反覆出現的情況****

8. ****whenever possible = 只要可能；在可以的情況下****

A very useful fixed expression.

Practice 14

> “Use fresh ingredients ****whenever possible****.”

「****只要情況許可 / 可以的話****，就使用新鮮食材。」

Practice 15

> “She walks instead of driving whenever possible.”

「****只要可以****，她都會步行而不是開車。」

****whenever possible = 在每一個可行的情況下；只要有可能就……****

9. ****whenever necessary = 每逢有需要；有需要時****

Practice 16

> “Water the plants **whenever necessary**.”

「**有需要時**就替植物澆水。」

Practice 17

> “The schedule can be changed whenever necessary.”

「時間表**有需要時**可以更改。」

whenever necessary = 每當有需要時

10. **whenever you like / want** — 你甚麼時候想.....都可以

A common conversational pattern.

Practice 18

> “Visit **whenever you like**.”

「你**甚麼時候**想來都可以。」

Practice 19

> “You can take a break whenever you want.”

「你**甚麼時候**想休息都可以。」

whenever you like/want = 由你自由選擇時間

11. **whenever** = when exactly? (有時表示驚訝 / 強調 , 較口語) — 到底甚麼時候

In some especially British/Irish conversational usage, **whenever** can appear where standard general English would use **when**, often adding surprise or emphasis.

Practice 20

> “**Whenever** did you find time to do all that?”

「你**到底甚麼時候**有時間做完這些事的？」

Practice 21

> “Whenever did that happen?”

「那件事**到底是甚麼時候**發生的？」

whenever — emphatic question = 到底甚麼時候

Register:

- * conversational
- * especially associated with some BrE/Irish usage
- * not the safest default learner usage

For ordinary questions, use:

> **When did that happen?**

12. **whenever = at whatever time / the time when, relative-like use — 在任何.....的時候**

Sometimes the clause behaves similarly to a nominal time expression.

Practice 22

> “Choose **whenever works best for you**.”

「選一個**對你最方便的時間**就可以。」

Practice 23

> “Whenever you choose will be fine.”

「你選的**任何時間**都可以。」

whenever = 任何符合條件的時間

This is more advanced, but useful.

Important distinction: **whenever vs when**

This is the biggest contrast.

when

can refer to:

- * one specific occasion;
- * a general time relationship.

> “Call me **when** you arrive.”

「你到達時打給我。」

Likely one specific arrival.

whenever

means:

- * every time;
- * any time;
- * no matter when.

> “Call me **whenever** you arrive in town.”

Depending on context:

「你**每次 / 無論甚麼時候**來到城裡都可以打給我。」

So:

> **when = 當……時 / 甚麼時候**

> **whenever = 每當 / 無論何時**

Important distinction: **whenever vs every time**

These are often very close.

whenever

> “Whenever she visits, she brings flowers.”

every time

> “Every time she visits, she brings flowers.”

Both:

「她每次來都會帶花。」

****Whenever**** is more compact and functions as a conjunction.

Important distinction: ****whenever vs anytime****

****whenever****

introduces a clause:

> “Come whenever you want.”

****anytime****

can stand more independently:

> “Come anytime.”

「隨時來都可以。」

In informal English:

> “Call me anytime.”

is very common.

So:

* whenever + clause

* anytime can stand alone more naturally

Important distinction: ****whenever vs wherever****

****whenever****

= no matter when / every time

→ 無論何時 / 每當

****wherever****

= no matter where / any place where

→ 無論哪裡 / 任何地方

> “Come whenever you like.”

vs

> “Sit wherever you like.”

Time vs place.

Important distinction: **whenever vs whatever**

whenever

= any/every time

whatever

= anything that / no matter what

> whenever you need help

> = 每當 / 無論何時你需要幫忙

> whatever you need

> = 你需要的任何東西

Important distinction: **whenever vs however**

whenever

= time

however

can mean:

* nevertheless

* no matter how

> whenever it happens

> = 無論何時發生

> however difficult it is

> = 無論多困難

Different grammatical dimension.

Important distinction: **whenever vs while**

whenever

= every/any time something happens

while

= during the time that something is happening

> “Whenever I garden, I feel calm.”

= 我每次做園藝都感到平靜。

> “While I garden, I listen to music.”

= 我做園藝的那段時間會聽音樂。

So:

* whenever = repeated occasion

* while = simultaneous duration

Important distinction: **whenever vs once**

whenever

= each/any time

once

can mean:

= when/as soon as something has happened once.

> “Whenever the fruit is ready, she gives some away.”

repeated habit.

> “Once the fruit is ready, we’ll pick it.”

one future stage:

「水果一成熟，我們就採。」

Important distinction: **whenever vs as soon as**

whenever

does not necessarily emphasize immediacy.

as soon as

means immediately after.

> “Whenever the plants need water, she waters them.”

= 每當植物需要水，她就澆水。

> “As soon as the plants need water, she waters them.”

= 植物一需要水，她就立即澆。

The second stresses immediate timing.

Important distinction: **whenever vs if**

if

= whether a condition happens.

whenever

= every time / any time that it happens.

> “If she comes, call me.”

= 如果她來，打給我。

> “Whenever she comes, call me.”

= 她每次來 / 無論何時來，都打給我。

****Whenever**** assumes repeated or unrestricted occasions more strongly.

Grammar note: ****no future will in ordinary time clauses****

For future reference:

> “Whenever she ****comes****, I’ll tell her.” 

Not normally:

> ***Whenever she will come, I’ll tell her.*** 

The future meaning is carried by the main clause/context.

Grammar note: ****comma placement****

When the whenever-clause comes first:

> “Whenever the tomatoes are ready, she gives some away.”

Use a comma.

When it comes second:

> “She gives some away whenever the tomatoes are ready.”

Usually no comma is needed.

Function sweep

After the full audit, the useful modern inventory is:

* ****whenever = every time that**** = 每當 / 每次.....時

* ****whenever = at any time that**** = 任何時候

* ****whenever = no matter when**** = 無論何時

* ****whenever + present for future reference**** = 未來時間子句常用現在式

* **whenever + past** = 過去每當.....
 * **whenever possible** = 只要可以
 * **whenever necessary** = 有需要時
 * **whenever you like/want** = 你甚麼時候想.....都可以
 * **whenever — emphatic question** = 到底甚麼時候，較口語 / 區域性
 * **whenever as time nominal** = 任何適合的時間

This is a compact grammar word, so I would stop here rather than manufacture extra “meanings.”

Master comparison

Form / pattern	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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whenever = every time that	某件事情每一次發生時，另一件事也發生；每當 / 每次
whenever = at any time that	不限定具體時間，在任何符合條件的時間都可以
whenever = no matter when	無論事情在甚麼時間發生，主句內容都成立
whenever + present, future meaning	表未來時間時，whenever 子句通常仍使用現在式
whenever + past	描述過去每次某情況發生時都出現的結果
whenever possible	在每一個可行的情況下；只要可以
whenever necessary	每當有需要時
whenever you like/want	時間由對方自由選擇；甚麼時候想.....都可以
whenever — emphatic question	用來加強「到底甚麼時候」的疑問；較口語 / 區域性
whenever — nominal time use	任何符合條件、適合的時間

For your original sentence

> “**Whenever** her tomatoes or lemons are ready, she gives some to neighbours and relatives...”

The exact meaning is:

whenever = 每一次她種的番茄或檸檬成熟可以採收時

So naturally:

> **「每當她的番茄或檸檬成熟可以採收時，她就會送一些給鄰居和親戚。」**

The highest-value contrasts are:

- > **when** → 當.....時 / 甚麼時候
- > **whenever** → 每當 / 無論何時
- > **every time** → 每次，與 whenever 很接近

- > ****whenever possible**** → 只要可以
- > ****whenever you like**** → 你甚麼時候想.....都可以
- > ****while**** → 在.....期間
- > ****if**** → 如果
- > ****as soon as**** → 一.....就..... / 一旦立即.....